

Firearms Trace Data: Massachusetts - 2023

Data Source: Firearms Tracing System

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

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ATF Firearms Trace Data Disclaimer

Firearm traces are designed to assist law enforcement authorities in conducting investigations by tracking the sale and possession of specific firearms. Law enforcement agencies may request firearms traces for any investigative reason, and those reasons are not necessarily reported to the federal government. Not all firearms used in crime are traced and not all firearms traced are used in crime.

Firearms selected for tracing are not chosen for purposes of determining which types, makes or models of firearms are used for illicit purposes. The firearms selected do not constitute a random sample and should not be considered representative of the larger universe of all firearms used by criminals, or any

subset of that universe. Firearms are normally traced to the first retail seller, and sources reported for firearms traced do not necessarily represent the sources or methods by which firearms in general are acquired for use in crime.

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced in Massachusetts in Calendar Year 2023

3,487

Firearm Types with a Massachusetts Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Pistols	2,590
Rifles	319
Revolvers	276
Shotguns	133
Receivers/Frames	67
Machinegun Conversion Devices	40
Machineguns	40
Derringers	15
Unknown Types	6
Any Other Weapon	1

Top Calibers Reported on Firearm Traces with a Massachusetts Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

9mm	1,633
.40 Cal	306
.22 Cal	267
.380 Cal	223
.45 Cal	184
.38 Cal	118
12GA	112
.357 Cal	65
MULTI	61
5.56mm	57

NOTE: There were 294 additional traces that were associated with other calibers. There were 167 traces with an unknown caliber.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with a Massachusetts Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Firearm Under Investigation	1,679
Possession of Weapon	797
Weapon Offense	380
Found Firearm	151

Dangerous Drugs	119
Aggravated Assault	76
Family Offense	47
Simple Assault	40
Suicide	37
Homicide	35

NOTE: There were 126 additional traces that were associated with other categories.

Top 15 Source States for Firearms with a Massachusetts Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Massachusetts	805
New Hampshire	248
Maine	225
Georgia	137
Florida	124
Vermont	81
North Carolina	69
South Carolina	63
Virginia	54
Rhode Island	51
Connecticut	47
Ohio	44

Texas	43
Alabama	35
Pennsylvania	31

NOTE: An additional 31 states and Puerto Rico accounted for 259 other traces.
The source state was identified in 2,316 total traces.

Time-To-Crime Rates for Firearms with a Massachusetts Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Under 3 Months	102
3 Months to Under 7 Months	112
7 Months to Under 1 Year	144
1 Year to Under 2 Years	301
2 Years to Under 3 Years	310
3 Years and Over	1,336

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 Massachusetts Average Time-to-Crime: **8.06 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Time-to-Crime: **6.76 Years**

Age of Possessors for Firearms with a Massachusetts Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

17 and Under	113
18 to 21	227

22 to 24	188
25 to 30	493
31 to 40	554
41 to 50	179
Over 50	267

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 Massachusetts Average Age of Possessor: **34 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Age of Possessor: **35 Years**

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with a Massachusetts Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Boston	441
Springfield	312
Worcester	166
Dorchester	155
Littleton	105
Brockton	102
Allston	87
Fall River	80
Lawrence	80
Lowell	76

NOTE: There were 249 additional municipalities that accounted for 1,882 other traces. The recovery city could not be determined for one trace.

Analytical Criteria Used to Compile the Enclosed Statistics

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced

- Includes traces with a recovery state of Massachusetts. Traces in which the recovery state was not provided were included when the requesting agency state was equal to Massachusetts.
- Includes Firearms Recovered and Traced between 1/1/2023 – 12/31/2023 or, if the recovery date was blank, firearms with trace entry dates between 1/1/2023 – 12/31/2023.
- Duplicate traces, Firearms Not Recovered, Gun Buyback and Firearms Turned In are not included in this figure.
- Data was extracted from the Firearms Tracing System (FTS) on April 10, 2024.
- All traces may not have been submitted or completed at the time of this study.

Firearm Types and Calibers with a Massachusetts Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with a Massachusetts Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Source States for Firearms with a Massachusetts Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser and the state in which the final dealer is located.

Time-to-Crime Rates for Firearms with a Massachusetts Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser.
- Time-to-Crime was calculated for those traces in which the purchase date could be subtracted from the recovery date.

Age of Possessors for Firearms with a Massachusetts Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces that provide a possessor and the possessor's date of birth.

- Possessor's age is calculated by subtracting the possessor's date of birth from the recovery date.

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with a Massachusetts Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces with a recovery city or, if the recovery city was not provided, traces requested by agencies with jurisdiction only within that city.

[View All 2023 Firearms Trace Data](#)

Last updated: December 9, 2024